

Problem 5. Mongo (25 marks)

Mongo, also called Nkundo, is a Bantu language spoken by several hundred thousand Mongo people in the Democratic Republic of the Congo.

Below are some verb forms in Mongo and their English translations. Note that an acute accent over a vowel (as in **á**) marks a high tone; the lack of it denotes a low tone.



ntáfingá	<i>I didn't insult.</i>
báólimisaka	<i>They forgave.</i>
lotájengenga	<i>You (pl) didn't fly today.</i>
áolalakaka	<i>He taught them today.</i>
óótobenganaka	<i>You (sg) ousted us.</i>
tóokogángelaka	<i>We scolded you (sg) today.</i>
totáabengáná	<i>We didn't oust them.</i>
atálotúta	<i>He didn't treat you (pl) today.</i>
lotáolímísá	<i>You (pl) didn't forgive him.</i>

Q 5.1 Translate the following into English. Note that one of the verb forms has two possible translations, give both.

- (a) **atákolaká**
- (b) **óototútaka**
- (c) **tóólofíngaka**
- (d) **ntájengéngá**

Q 5.2 Translate the following into Mongo.

- (a) *You (pl) flew.*
- (b) *I didn't scold you (pl).*
- (c) *You (sg) forgave him today.*
- (d) *They didn't insult us today.*

Q 5.3 Explain your solution.